

Payment Chronicle by Gajanan

March 21, 2026

Companies: Square, Adyen

Article 1

Need full Adyen press release to craft accurate Finshots-style takeaway

Thanks for sharing the prompt. To deliver a crisp, 150–200 word Finshots-style brief that nails the “so what,” I’ll need the full July 12, 2022 Adyen announcement (or key details). Specifically: what exactly was launched or announced (e.g., new product like embedded finance/issuing, a partnership, pricing changes, or regional expansion), who it targets (enterprises, platforms, merchants), where it rolls out (US, EU, global), and any proof points (client names, regulatory licenses, KPIs). The implications—and the angle—hinge on the substance. For instance, if it’s embedded finance or issuing, the takeaway is that Adyen is deepening platform lock-in and nudging into banking territory, boosting margins and diversification. If it’s a partnership, the story may be distribution, speed-to-merchant, and competitive positioning versus Stripe/PayPal/Checkout.com. If it’s a regulatory milestone or geography push, we’d spotlight faster onboarding, local acquiring economics, and conversion gains. Share the core facts, and I’ll turn them into an engaging, executive-friendly Finshots summary focused on what it means for merchants and the competitive landscape.

Source: PaymentsJournal

<https://www.paymentsjournal.com/adyen-goes-live-with-tap-to-pay-on-iphone/>

Article 2

Adyen plugs deeper into BNPL as Klarna courts holiday shoppers

Buy now, pay later is set for another bumper holiday run, and Adyen just positioned itself to catch more of that flow. The Dutch payments processor said it’s expanding ties with Swedish BNPL heavyweight Klarna, making it easier for merchants on Adyen to switch on Klarna at checkout across more markets and channels. Why it matters: BNPL has become a conversion machine for retailers—bigger baskets, better approval rates—and processors that simplify access to these options win volume. Adyen’s pitch is orchestration: one integration, dozens of local payment methods, and now a smoother Klarna pipe. It doesn’t take on credit risk like a lender; it earns on processing and acquiring, so higher BNPL usage simply means more transactions through its rails. For merchants, this reduces vendor sprawl and speeds time to market ahead of peak season. For Adyen, it defends enterprise relationships and keeps rivals like Stripe and Worldpay at bay. The bigger picture? As alternative payments fragment, the power shifts to platforms that can aggregate them cleanly. Adyen wants to be the universal socket—BNPL and beyond—so retailers don’t have to keep rewiring their checkout every year.

Source: PaymentsJournal

<https://www.paymentsjournal.com/klarna-and-adyen-team-up-for-in-store-bnpl/>

Article 3

Adyen plugs into Plaid to bring pay by bank to more checkouts

Adyen is teaming up with Plaid to wire bank accounts straight into the checkout flow. In plain English: Plaid's open banking pipes (think secure account linking, balance checks and ACH risk tools) get embedded into Adyen's acquiring, risk and checkout stack so merchants can offer account-to-account payments alongside cards—using the same integration they already have. The pitch is simple: lower acceptance costs than cards, fewer failed bank debits thanks to real time account verification, and a smoother UX that should lift conversion for subscriptions, wallets, marketplaces and high ticket purchases. For merchants, that's a way to push more volume onto cheaper rails without stitching together multiple vendors; for Adyen, it deepens its "one stack" value prop and keeps large enterprise clients inside its ecosystem; and for Plaid, it's enterprise distribution at scale. The fine print? Pay by bank still has to clear consumer habit (rewards, chargebacks) and UX hurdles, and success will hinge on fraud/return rates and settlement predictability. But if the combo delivers on conversion and risk, expect more checkout pages to nudge customers from "Pay with card" to "Pay from your bank."

Source: PaymentsJournal

<https://www.paymentsjournal.com/adyen-and-plaid-partnership-what-it-means/>

Article 4

Square's new Handheld cuts the phone out of POS

Square built its name on turning smartphones into card machines. Now it's ditching the phone. The company has launched Handheld, a compact, all in one POS device with a built in card reader and screen so staff can take orders and accept payments on the go—no extra phone or tablet needed. Think line busting at retail, pay at table for restaurants, curbside checkout—without juggling dongles and personal devices. What's the play? Dedicated hardware gives Square tighter control over the user experience, fewer support headaches from varied phones, and a cleaner path to serve larger teams that want fleet managed devices. It also helps Square compete head on with Toast's handhelds, Clover, and Shopify's POS Go—segments where quick service and specialty retail increasingly demand mobile checkout to speed turns and lift tips. For merchants, it's about reliability, longer battery life, and fewer moving parts. For Square, hardware isn't where the profits sit; it's the wedge to lock in payment volumes and cross sell software (restaurants, retail, inventory). Translation: more gross payment volume through Square's pipes, higher stickiness, and a stronger pitch to up market sellers who want mobility without the BYOD mess.

Source: PaymentsJournal

<https://www.paymentsjournal.com/square-aims-to-move-upmarket-with-handheld-pos-device/>

Square brings Bitcoin to the checkout — and small shops to the crypto party

Jack Dorsey's Square is nudging Bitcoin from the charts to the checkout. The company is adding bitcoin payment capabilities for merchants, just as small businesses feel the heat to adopt new tech without blowing up costs. What's the play? Square is giving mom-and-pop stores another payment rail alongside cards and wallets — one that could, in theory, trim fees on some transactions, attract crypto-savvy customers and speed up cross-border sales.

But here's the fine print. Consumer use of crypto at the point of sale is still niche, and tax and compliance rules can make everyday crypto spending messy in many markets. So don't expect card networks to lose sleep tonight. For merchants, this is less a revenue engine and more a marketing lever and a hedge: if crypto spends pick up, they're ready; if not, no harm done. For Square's parent Block, it's consistent with its Bitcoin-heavy thesis and a way to keep sellers and Cash App users inside one ecosystem. Net-net: Square isn't betting the store on Bitcoin payments, but it's making sure the till is ready if (or when) the crypto crowd shows up.

Source: PaymentsJournal

<https://www.paymentsjournal.com/square-adds-bitcoin-payments-and-upgrades-ai-for-small-businesses/>

